

Bhagavad Gītā · Concept KG

A Madhva siddhānta reading

Concept Graph · Madhva

Why this exists

The Gītā's 700 verses interweave cosmology, ethics, and metaphysics across hundreds of distinct concepts. Reading the text linearly works once — but the structural ties between every yoga, doṣa, yajña and phala are easy to lose. This Concept KG lays the whole network out — every concept anchored in a verse, every relation typed and labeled, read through the Madhva-siddhānta lens.

The twelve tiers

Concepts are organised into twelve tiers — a ladder of being from the supreme Hari down through symbol and metaphor. Each tier groups concepts of the same kind. Edges (is-a, leads-to, antidote-to, arises-from, opposite-of, includes, predicates-on, transforms-into) connect them as the Gītā itself does, verse by verse.

● Paramārtha	<i>Ultimate reality — Hari, the sarvottama</i>	● Tattva	<i>Metaphysical categories — jīva, prakṛti, kāla</i>
● Kṣetra-Kṣetrajña	<i>Field & field-knower — body, knower, 24 elements (Ch 13)</i>	● Guṇa	<i>The three modes of prakṛti — sattva, rajas, tamas</i>
● Yoga	<i>Paths — karma, jñāna, bhakti, dhyāna, sannnyāsa</i>	● Sādhana	<i>Practices — śraddhā, vairāgya, yajña, tapas, tyāga</i>
● Antaḥkaraṇa	<i>Inner instrument — manas, buddhi, ahaṅkāra, indriyas</i>	● Dharma	<i>Ethics — svadharma, niṣkāma-karma, sthita-prajña</i>
● Doṣa	<i>Defects — kāma, krodha, lobha, moha, asat-saṅga</i>	● Phala	<i>Goals & states — mokṣa, paramagati, brāhmī-sthiti</i>
● Yajña	<i>Sacrifice varieties — dravya, tapo, jñāna, svādhyāya</i>	● Pratīka	<i>Symbols & metaphors — aśvattha, ratha, praṇava</i>

Paramārtha

Ultimate reality. The Gītā's topmost concept is not an impersonal absolute but Hari — Viṣṇu, the puruṣottama who stands beyond the kṣara (perishable jīvas) and the akṣara (the kūṭastha, Lakṣmī). Krishna names this in Ch 15 with the puruṣottama-yoga.

Brahman — the Supreme

BG 8.3 · 14.27 · 15.18

For Madhva, Brahman names Viṣṇu/Nārāyaṇa alone — sarvottama, the puruṣottama beyond kṣara and akṣara. Not a generic 'absolute'.

Paramātman — the indweller

BG 13.22 · 15.17

The 'highest Self' standing in every body as the witness, sustainer, ordainer. Distinct from jīva (BG 15.17).

Puruṣottama — the supreme person

BG 15.18-19

Krishna's self-designation as the puruṣa beyond the perishable and the imperishable. The hermeneutic center of Ch 15.

The imperishable puruṣa

BG 15.16

The kūṭa-stha — for Madhva, Lakṣmī, the eternally-liberated jīva-gaṇa-mukhya. Sarvottama after Hari.

Tattva

Metaphysical categories. The aparā prakṛti (eightfold material nature) and the parā prakṛti (jīva-bhūtā) lay out reality. Time, action, and svabhāva sit alongside them. Madhva keeps every category as a real, distinct ontological item — never collapsed into one Brahman.

The embodied self

BG 15.7

An eternal aṁśa of Hari (BG 15.7) — real, distinct, plural, never merged with Brahman. Bound by avidyā until released.

Material nature

BG 7.4–5 · 9.10

Hari's own lower nature — eightfold: earth, water, fire, air, ether, manas, buddhi, ahaṅkāra. The womb of all forms.

Innate nature

BG 5.14 · 8.3 · 18.41

Each jīva has a beginningless intrinsic nature (sva-rūpa-yogyatā in Madhva). Determines varṇa, capacities, and ultimate destination.

The Lord as ordainer

BG 18.61

Hari as antaryāmī — stands in every heart and directs (yantra-ārūḍha-māyā) the jīvas as if mounted on a machine.

Kṣetra-Kṣetrajña

Field & field-knower. The body is the field (kṣetra); the jīva inside it is the knower (kṣetrajña); and within every body Krishna himself stands as the highest kṣetrajña. The 24 elements of kṣetra and their seven vikāras are laid out in Ch 13.

The field-knower

BG 13.2

The witness who knows the field. Krishna: 'kṣetrajñaṃ cāpi māṃ viddhi sarva-kṣetreṣu bhārata' — Hari is the highest kṣetrajña.

The field (body)

BG 13.1 · 13.5-6

This body, with its 24 elements (mahābhūtas, ahaṅkāra, buddhi, avyakta, indriyas, mind, viśayas, will, dveṣa, sukha, duḥkha, saṅghāta, cetanā, dhṛti).

The five gross elements

BG 13.5

Earth, water, fire, air, ether — first five of the 24 kṣetra constituents.

The unmanifest

BG 13.5 · 8.18

Mūla-prakṛti before evolutes. From it emerge mahat, ahaṅkāra, and the tanmātras.

Guṇa

The three modes of prakṛti — sattva (clarity, knowledge), rajas (passion, action), tamas (inertia, delusion). Chapters 14, 17, 18 trace every action, food, sacrifice and knowledge back to its guṇa. Liberation is described as guṇātīta — going beyond all three.

Mode of clarity	<i>BG 14.6 · 14.11</i>
Light, luminous, healthful — binds the jīva through attachment to happiness and knowledge. Predominates in the wise.	
Mode of passion	<i>BG 14.7 · 14.12</i>
Of the nature of craving and attachment; born of thirst (tṛṣṇā) and clinging (saṅga). Drives ceaseless action.	
Mode of darkness	<i>BG 14.8 · 14.13</i>
Born of ajñāna — deludes all embodied beings; binds through negligence, indolence, sleep.	
Beyond the guṇas	<i>BG 14.22–25</i>
One in whom no guṇa-impulse arises by attachment; treats friend and foe alike; abandons all undertakings.	

Yoga

The paths. Karma-yoga (selfless action), jñāna-yoga (knowledge), bhakti-yoga (devotion), dhyāna-yoga (meditation), sannyāsa (renunciation). For Madhva, bhakti is not one path among others — it is the indispensable means and a constituent of mokṣa itself.

Path of devotion	<i>BG 9.22 · 11.54 · 18.55</i>
Loving knowledge of Hari that exceeds all other knowledge. For Madhva, bhakti is sthira-jñāna-pūrvika-prema — the indispensable cause of mokṣa.	
Self-surrender to Hari	<i>BG 18.66</i>
'sarva-dharmān parityajya mām ekaṃ śaraṇaṃ vraja' — the closing teaching. Total taking-of-refuge in Hari, who then absolves all sin.	
Path of selfless action	<i>BG 3.3 · 3.19 · 5.2</i>
Doing one's duty as an offering to Hari, surrendering all fruits. The path Krishna prescribes most often to Arjuna.	
Path of discriminative knowledge	<i>BG 3.3 · 4.33–38</i>
Knowing Hari as supreme, jīva as His aṁśa, world as His dependent reality. The means for the qualified.	

Sādhana

Practices. Śraddhā (faith), vairāgya (dispassion), abhyāsa (steady practice), tapas, dāna, satsaṅga, japa, smaraṇa, śaraṇāgati. The Gītā treats these not as one's own doing but as means appointed by the Lord through which grace flows.

Faith

BG 17.2-3

Faith follows one's nature; one is what one's faith is. Threefold by guṇa — sātṭvika in gods, rājasa in yakṣas, tāmasa in spirits.

Dispassion

BG 6.35 · 13.8-11

Detachment from sense-objects — not life-rejection but the seeing-through of binding attractions.

Repeated practice

BG 6.26 · 12.9

The 'samādhi-abhyāsa' — bringing back the wandering mind, again and again, to Hari.

Austerity (3-fold)

BG 17.14-19

Tapas of body (worship/cleanliness/celibacy), of speech (truth/kindness/study), of mind (serenity/silence/self-control). All threefold by guṇa.

Antaḥkaraṇa

The inner instrument. Manas, buddhi, ahaṅkāra plus the eleven indriyas — sensory and motor. Krishna teaches their command in Ch 6 (saṁyama) and the danger of dragged indriyas in Ch 2.67.

Indweller — Hari within

BG 18.61

'īśvaraḥ sarva-bhūtānāṃ hṛd-deśe tiṣṭhati' — the Lord stands in the heart of every being, directing them.

Mind

BG 6.34-35 · 3.6-7

The eleventh indriya. Restless, turbulent, hard to subdue — but Krishna affirms it is conquerable by abhyāsa and vairāgya.

Discriminating intellect

BG 18.30-32

That faculty which discriminates duty from non-duty, what to do from what not to do. Sāttvika buddhi knows pravṛtti and nivṛtti.

I-maker

BG 3.27 · 7.4

The sense of being the doer. 'kartāham iti manyate' — when the puruṣa is bewildered by ahaṅkāra he thinks himself the agent.

Dharma

Ethics. Svadharma (one's own duty), niṣkāma-karma (action without attachment to fruit), sthita-prajña (the established intellect), abhaya, ahiṃsā, sama-darśana. Dharma is not abandoned for mokṣa — it is the road to it.

One's own duty BG 3.35 · 18.47
'better one's own dharma poorly done than another's well done' — performing the duty arising from one's svabhāva.

Duties by intrinsic nature BG 4.13 · 18.41-44
Brāhmaṇa, kṣatriya, vaiśya, śūdra — duties arising from guṇa-karma-vibhāga. Madhva: rooted in eternal sva-rūpa-yogyatā.

Desireless action BG 2.47 · 4.20
Action performed without desire for its result. The signature ethical demand of the BG.

One of steady wisdom BG 2.55-72
Indifferent to pleasure and pain, free of attachment, fear, anger; senses fully withdrawn. Closing portrait of Ch 2.

Doṣa

Defects. Kāma (desire), krodha (anger), lobha (greed) — the threefold gate to hell (16.21). Moha, ahaṅkāra-mamatā, asat-saṅga, asurī-sampad. The Gītā maps each doṣa with its arising-from cause and its antidote.

Demonic endowment

BG 16.4 · 16.7-20

Hypocrisy, arrogance, conceit, anger, harshness, ignorance — the inverse of divine endowment. Leads to bondage.

Desire

BG 3.37-39

'this is the enemy here, born of rajas, all-devouring, greatly sinful' — Krishna names kāma as the primary foe.

Anger

BG 2.62-63 · 3.37

From kāma-vighāta (blocked desire) arises krodha; from krodha, delusion; from delusion, loss of memory.

Greed

BG 16.21

One of the three gates of hell, alongside kāma and krodha. To be abandoned at the threshold of the path.

Phala

Goals & states. Mokṣa, paramā-gati, brāhmī-sthiti, the four mukti-gradations (sālokya, sāmīpya, sārūpya, sāyujya). For Madhva, mokṣa is real but tāratamya-graded — not undifferentiated bliss.

Liberation

BG 5.24–26 · 18.66

Release from saṃsāra into Hari's eternal presence. For Madhva: gradations of mokṣa (sālokya, sārṣṭi, sāmīpya, sārūpya, sāyujya).

Fruit of surrender

BG 18.66

'I will release you from all sins; do not grieve' — Krishna's guarantee at 18.66. For Madhva, the crown of the Gītā.

Co-residence in Hari's world

BG 8.21 · 15.6

First grade of mokṣa: dwelling in the same loka as Hari (Vaikuṇṭha) — but not yet in His proximity.

Nearness to Hari

BG 11.55

Second grade: proximity to Hari in His own abode. Beyond sālokya, not yet sārūpya.

Yajña

Sacrifice. Dravya-yajña (substance offering), tapo-yajña, jñāna-yajña, svādhyāya-yajña, prāṇāyāma-yajña, indriya-samyama. Ch 4 turns every action into yajña when offered to Hari.

Sacrifice of substance BG 4.28
Offering material wealth — first of Krishna's catalogue of yajñas at BG 4.28.

Sacrifice of austerity BG 4.28
Offering one's tapas — bodily, vocal, mental austerities — as worship.

Sacrifice of yoga BG 4.28-30
Offering one's yogic discipline — prāṇa-apāna control, eightfold yoga — as worship of Hari.

Sacrifice of study & knowledge BG 4.28
Recitation of scripture together with the knowledge it discloses — the highest verbal yajña.

Pratīka

Symbols & metaphors. Aśvattha (the inverted world-tree, Ch 15), ratha (the body-chariot — implicit from Kaṭha), praṇava (oṃ), gītā-māhātmya, vibhūti. The image-language through which abstract tattva enters the heart.

The inverted fig-tree

BG 15.1-3

Roots above (Hari), branches below (the worlds); fed by the guṇas, sprouting sense-objects. Cut it with the axe of non-attachment.

The chariot allegory

BG 1.21-25 ·
18.78

Implied throughout Ch 1-2: Krishna the sārathi (charioteer), Arjuna the rathin (warrior on the chariot). Echo of Kaṭha Up.

The syllable Om

BG 8.13 · 17.23

'oṃ ity ekākṣaraṃ brahma' — uttering Om at the moment of death, remembering Hari, one attains the supreme.

'I am the letter A'

BG 10.33

Among letters, Krishna says, 'I am A' — the source of all phonemes; among compounds, the dvandva.

Edge vocabulary

Eight typed relations carry the structure of the Gītā's thought:

 identity / membership — Brahman is-a paramātman

 cure for a doṣa — jñāna antidote-to ajñāna

 polar pair — sattva opposite-of tamas

 depends on — kṣetrajña predicates-on kṣetra

 sādhana → phala — karma-yoga leads-to citta-śuddhi

 causal genesis — krodha arises-from kāma

 whole-part — kṣetra includes mahābhūtas

 modal shift — sattva transforms-into sāttvika-jñāna

The map

Twelve horizontal bands — paramārtha at the top, pratīka at the bottom. Every node sits on its tier band, every edge is colored by its relation type. The structural shape of the Gītā's thought, seen from above.



Hari's absolute supremacy

The axiom anchoring tāratamya: Hari is highest, no one his equal or superior.
Every other being is strictly subordinate.

Foundational Madhva siddhānta — pañca-bheda starts here.

Anchor verse

BG 7.7

mattaḥ parataraṃ nānyat kiñcid asti
dhanañjaya |

BG 7.7 · 11.43 · 18.65

Five real differences

Hari-jīva, Hari-jaḍa, jīva-jaḍa, jīva-jīva, jaḍa-jaḍa — five eternal differences that Madhva siddhānta defends as ontologically real.

Madhva-defining. Each bheda is anchored in BG (jīva 15.7, jīva-jīva-bheda implicit in svabhāva 18.41ff).

Anchor verse

BG 15.7

mamaivāṁśo jīva-loke jīva-bhūtaḥ sanātanaḥ
|

BG 7.4-5 · 15.7 · 15.16-18

Gradation of being

The strict hierarchy of all reality under Hari — every soul has a definite, irreversible rank. The architectural principle of Madhva metaphysics.

Distinctively Madhva. Underwrites pañca-bheda and the gradations of mukti.

Anchor verse

BG 7.7

mattaḥ parataraṁ nānyat kiñcid asti
dhanañjaya |
mayi sarvam idaṁ protaṁ sūtre maṇi-gaṇā
iva ||

BG 7.7 · 15.16–18

Fruit of surrender

'I will release you from all sins; do not grieve' — Krishna's guarantee at 18.66. For Madhva, the crown of the Gītā.

The carama-śloka — Madhva's direct mokṣa-upadeśa.

Anchor verse

BG 18.66

sarva-dharmān parityajya mām ekaṃ
śaraṇaṃ vraja |
ahaṃ tvā sarva-pāpebhyo mokṣayiṣyāmi mā
śucaḥ ||

BG 18.66

The embodied self

An eternal aṁśa of Hari (BG 15.7) — real, distinct, plural, never merged with Brahman. Bound by avidyā until released.

Jīva-bheda is real (pañca-bheda #1). Plurality of jīvas is eternal.

Anchor verse

BG 15.7

mamaivāṁśo jīva-loke jīva-bhūtaḥ sanātanaḥ
|
manaḥ-ṣaṣṭhānīndriyāṇi prakṛti-sthāni
karṣati ||

BG 15.7

How to use the viewer

- Browse — every concept under its tier, with live search
- Focus — verse anchor, doctrinal note, Madhva callout, every relation
- Map — all 112 concepts on one celestial canvas

Quad-script toggle: English · Devanāgarī · Hindi · Kannada — one tap to switch.

Sources

- Primary — Bhagavad Gītā (Sanskrit verse, every concept anchored)
- Commentary — Madhva, Gītā-bhāṣya
- Modern exposition — Bannanje Govindacharya, Gītā-bhāṣya (4 vols, Kannada)
- Doctrinal lens — BNK Sharma, Philosophy of Śrī Madhvācārya
- Standard — every node grounded in verse + tradition; no editorial gloss

What's in the graph

112

Concepts

124

Relations

12

Tiers

112

Verse anchors

github.com/kvinayakpai/Bhagavadgita

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namaḥ pārtha-sārathaye

śrī-kṛṣṇārpaṇam astu